



THE ANDEAN CARAVAN • DAYS 24-39

02

Both Shores

Titicaca, La Paz and the cloud forest

A proposal you can picture yourself inside

A caravan is not a race down a route. It is a moving circle — travellers, hosts, vehicles and local knowledge — progressing slowly enough for each place to change the terms.

Section 02 is the second of four sections that tile one continuous 71-day passage from Lima to the end of the Carretera Austral. It begins at the Puno gate and closes at the Sucre gate, where travellers may leave the Caravan or continue south into Section 03.

01 23 DAYS	02 16 DAYS	03 18 DAYS	04 14 DAYS	
LIMA	PUNO	SUCRE	SANTIAGO	BALMACEDA
YOUR GATES		Join at Puno, leave at Sucre. There is no roadside boarding and no mid-section joining point in this section.		

IMPORTANT

This is a route proposal, not yet a confirmed departure.

It communicates the intended route, pace and level of effort. Exact dates, named properties, suppliers, tickets, departure times, prices and meal inclusions become final only after the 2028 operating plan is secured. Weather, permits, border authorities and vessel operators can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Effort is more than walking distance

Every day separates physical effort from the operating environment. A short day can still be demanding if it sleeps high, begins early, changes hotels or removes access to easy recovery.

PHYSICAL EFFORT

■ LIGHT

Arrival, recovery, buffer or compact programme. The point is to create room around the harder days.

■ STEADY

A normal travelling day: walking, road movement, a visit or a hotel change without concentrated load.

■ DEMANDING

Long movement, significant altitude, rough ground, early start, complex boarding or several load signals together.

OPERATING ENVIRONMENT

CONNECTED

Reliable services and straightforward access to support.

LIMITED SERVICES

Fewer choices and slower access to support; planning matters.

REMOTE

Simple infrastructure, long transfer routes and limited communications or facilities.

FREE TIME

When the guide says free time, it means genuinely uncommitted time. It is not a space waiting to be filled later by a compulsory tour.

Both Shores

A lake-and-city journey at altitude: the inhabited islands of Titicaca, a foot crossing into Bolivia, Isla del Sol, La Paz and Tiwanaku, then a descent into the Yungas before flying to Sucre.

HIGHEST POINT

Approx. 4,115 m at Pachatata

MOVEMENT

Road, passenger boat, vehicle barge, foot border and flight

SLEEP RANGE

Approx. 1,700 m to 3,850 m

SEASON

Late February to mid-March — wet season

THE STAGES

The Islands and the Border	Days 24–31
Thin Air and Cloud Forest	Days 32–39

Most of this section is spent above 3,600 m, and the lake has authority over three of its days.

24 Uros, then a quiet Puno afternoon

ROUTE

Puno to Uros to Puno

SLEEP

Puno

MOVEMENT

Half-day passenger boat

RHYTHM

■ Light · Limited services

A contained morning reaches Uros and returns to Puno. The visit is community-led and avoids treating the islands as floating scenery. The afternoon is protected after the previous day's long train, or after the joiner's arrival progression.

FREE TIME *From early afternoon.*

25 Taquile to Amantaní

ROUTE

Puno to Taquile to Amantaní

SLEEP

Family house on Amantaní

MOVEMENT

Approx. 4 to 5 hours boat across the day

RHYTHM

■ Demanding · Remote

An early proposed private launch reaches Taquile through a community-agreed landing with a smaller climb. This reduces, but does not remove, steps. A shortened textile and cultural visit with lunch is followed by the inter-island boat to Amantaní, aiming to arrive by mid-afternoon and well before dark.

FREE TIME *A quiet period after meeting the host family and settling in.*

26 Amantaní with two morning routes

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Amantaní to Puno	Puno	Optional hill walk and approx. 3.5 hours boat	■ Steady · Remote

An early visit towards Pachatata is offered only with the host community and when local access permits. It is optional. A village-level morning is a complete parallel choice. The boat returns to Puno in early afternoon.

FREE TIME *After the return to Puno.*

27 Puno, and the day the lake may have taken

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Puno	Puno	None unless recovery of lost island time is required	■ Light · Connected

The whole day is held. If wind or swell shortened Taquile, displaced the Amantaní stay or forced an early return, this is where that time is recovered — with the community, at the community's convenience, not squeezed into an already-full day. If the lake behaved, the day belongs to rest, laundry, a slower Puno and individual time before the border.

FREE TIME *The whole day when the buffer is not needed.*

WHY THE BUFFER	This buffer remains unprogrammed. It is not back-filled with a compulsory excursion or converted into an optional paid tour.
LAUNDRY	A laundry opportunity is planned here; it is expected to be one of only two reliable ones between Cusco and Sucre.

28 Walk the border at Kasani

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Puno to Kasani to Copacabana	Copacabana	Approx. 4 to 6 hours road and formalities	■ Steady · Limited services

The road reaches Kasani, where travellers complete Peruvian and Bolivian controls and walk the short distance between them. Vehicles and luggage transfer under the arranged cross-border plan. Copacabana is the day's end, not a launch point for another boat.

FREE TIME *After border completion and check-in.*

29 Cross to Isla del Sol

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Copacabana to Isla del Sol	Southern Isla del Sol	Approx. 1.5 to 2 hours boat	■ Steady · Remote

A passenger boat reaches the southern or Yumani sector. The day uses a short island route rather than a full ridge traverse. Luggage assistance is arranged from the landing to the selected property.

FREE TIME *A substantial late afternoon on the island.*

30 Isla del Sol, then Copacabana

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Isla del Sol to Copacabana	Copacabana	Short walk and passenger boat	■ Steady · Remote

A short southern-island route uses paths confirmed locally open at the time. The group returns to Copacabana in early afternoon. The schedule does not depend on crossing the entire island.

FREE TIME *The afternoon in Copacabana.*

31 Tiquina and the descent into La Paz

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Copacabana to Tiquina to La Paz	La Paz	Approx. 4 to 5.5 hours road and barge	■ Steady · Limited services

The vehicle crosses the Tiquina strait by barge before the road rises to El Alto and descends into La Paz. Nothing is programmed after check-in.

FREE TIME *After arrival.*

32 La Paz from above

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz	La Paz	Cable car and short road links	Light · Connected

The city begins with a cable-car overview and a contained neighbourhood orientation. The purpose is to understand the basin without asking travellers to climb it. The day ends early.

FREE TIME *From mid-afternoon.*

33 La Paz at street level

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz	La Paz	Vehicle, cable car and adapted city walk	Steady · Connected

A compact route through the historic core and selected markets uses vehicle and cable-car support to limit steep walking. It avoids turning the city into an inventory of viewpoints.

FREE TIME *A protected late afternoon.*

34 Tiwanaku

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz to Tiwanaku to La Paz	La Paz	Full-day road excursion	■ Steady · Limited services

The route travels to Tiwanaku for a full visit at a measured pace and returns to La Paz. The site sits around 3,850 m. Walking is broken by interpretation and vehicle placement rather than compressed into one exposed circuit.

FREE TIME *Only after return to La Paz.*

35 A day with room

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz	La Paz	None required	■ Light · Connected

The whole day is kept open after the Titicaca crossing, the La Paz arrival and two days of city and archaeological content. It belongs to sleep, laundry, a pharmacy or practical errand, individual wandering or doing nothing.

FREE TIME *The whole day. It is not back-filled with a compulsory tour.*

PROTECTED RECOVERY	This recovery day remains genuinely open. Any optional individual activity may be declined so the day can remain completely free.
LAUNDRY	A laundry opportunity is planned here, subject to final confirmation.

36 Down into the Yungas

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz to Coroico	Coroico	Approx. 3.5 to 5 hours road	■ Steady · Limited services

The Caravan uses the modern Coroico road to descend from the high basin into the Yungas. Proper comfort stops are part of the day. The Death Road is not used. Arrival is early enough that Coroico feels like a change of climate rather than the end of an endurance drive.

FREE TIME *After arrival and check-in.*

37 Coffee country and cloud forest

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Coroico	Coroico	Short local road links	■ Light · Limited services

A gentle local programme may include coffee-growing landscapes, a grower's workshop or a small visit selected with the host community. Walking remains optional. The day is intentionally modest so the climate shift can register in the body as well as the itinerary.

FREE TIME *Most of the afternoon.*

38 Return to La Paz

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Coroico to La Paz	La Paz	Approx. 3.5 to 5 hours road	■ Steady · Limited services

The modern road returns to La Paz with no fixed afternoon visit. This protected night absorbs wet-season road variation and places the group in the city before the flight.

FREE TIME After arrival, subject to road conditions.

39 Fly to Sucre

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
La Paz to Sucre	Sucre	Scheduled flight and transfers	■ Light · Connected

A direct scheduled flight is used if the 2028 timetable supports it. Sucre sits lower than La Paz and begins with arrival and rest rather than a compressed city visit.

FREE TIME After check-in.

Where this section asks more of you

Most of the section is spent above 3,600 m, apart from the two Coroico nights at approximately 1,700 m and the final Sucre gate night at approximately 2,800 m.

Three days use small passenger boats at high altitude. Boarding, toilet, shade, warmth and motion exposure require exact disclosure.

Taquile and Isla del Sol contain steep paths and substantial steps. Planned landings and shorter routes reduce the barrier but do not create step-free access.

The optional Pachatata route rises above 4,100 m before breakfast. A lower route is offered without penalty.

Kasani is an international border. Queues, document issues and the cross-border vehicle change can extend the day.

The Coroico road is subject to wet-season landslides and closures. The modern road is used, never the Death Road.

The section ends with a scheduled flight that the structure depends on. The road alternative is not a same-day substitute.

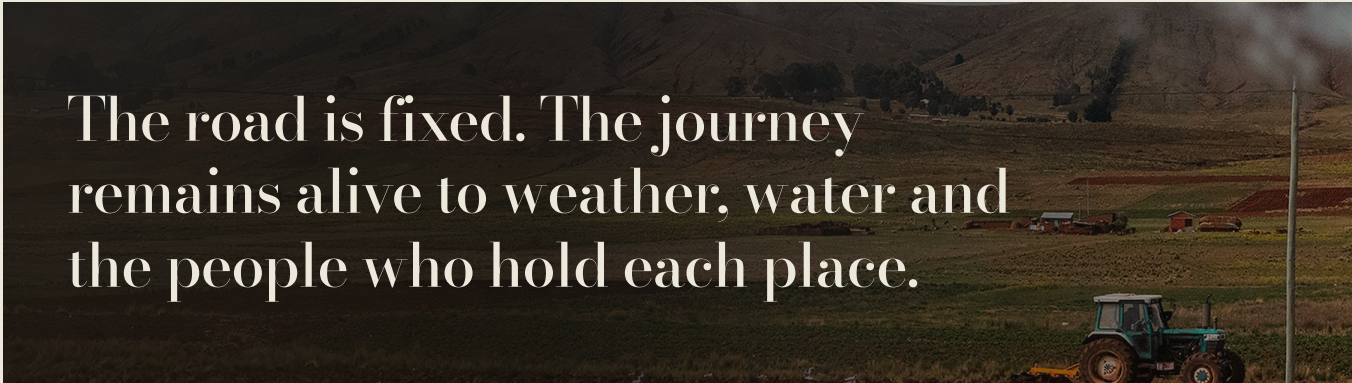
SLEEP PATTERN

Puno four nights across the stage, including the Day 27 buffer. Copacabana two, Amantaní one family house, Isla del Sol one. La Paz five nights across two stops, with Day 35 held entirely open. Coroico two. Sucre closes the section at the Caravan standard and is the gate night for Section 03.

From route proposal to your departure

This guide is the clearest picture of the intended journey through Both Shores. Before this section is offered as a secured departure, Sawayatra will reconcile the calendar, contract the route-critical trains, flights, ferries, refuges and local encounters, inspect access and accommodation, and publish the exact inclusion and cancellation terms.

-
- | | | |
|----|-----------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Choose the passage | One section, consecutive sections, The Stone Road, or the full 71 days. |
| 02 | Discuss readiness | Altitude, walking, access, room basis, luggage and the demands that matter to you. |
| 03 | Receive the secured detail | Dates, price, properties, flights, inclusions, medical and insurance requirements, and the final day plan. |
-



The road is fixed. The journey remains alive to weather, water and the people who hold each place.